

Zihao Zhao

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Reasoning, learning, and efficient orchestration in LLM-based multi-agent systems.

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign Sept. 2026–Present

Ph.D. student in Information Sciences Advisor: Hao Wang

Rutgers University–New Brunswick Aug. 2025–Aug. 2026

Doctoral studies in Computer Science Advisor: Hao Wang

Shanghai Jiao Tong University Sept. 2021–June 2025

B.Eng. in Automation, Zhiyuan Honors Program (top 5% of cohort)

PUBLICATIONS

Published and accepted papers. † Equal contribution.

1. **Zihao Zhao**, Tunyu Zhang, Haizhou Shi, Yusong Zhao, Xinxi Zhang, and Hao Wang
When Debate Helps: Proposal Supply and Verification-Aware Readout in Multi-Agent Reasoning
NeurIPS, 2026. Accepted. [paper]
2. King Yeung Tsang†, **Zihao Zhao**†, et al.
Reward Modeling for Multi-Agent Orchestration
NeurIPS, 2026. Accepted. [paper]
3. Tunyu Zhang, **Zihao Zhao**, et al.
Sequential Probabilistic Uncertainty Estimation for Parallel Multi-Agent Reasoning Systems
NeurIPS, 2026. Accepted. [paper]
4. Wenyuan Wang, Yusong Zhao, ..., **Zihao Zhao**, ..., Hao Wang
Probabilistic Residual Learning for Online Recommendations
RecSys, 2026. Accepted. [paper]
5. Yiyang Zhou, Linjie Li, ..., **Zihao Zhao**, ..., Huaxiu Yao
GLIMPSE: Do Large Vision-Language Models Truly Think With Videos or Just Glimpse at Them?
EMNLP, 2025, pp. 27842–27856. [paper]
6. Sihan Yang, Chenhang Cui, **Zihao Zhao**, et al.
Improving Alignment in LVLMs with Debaised Self-Judgment
Findings of EMNLP, 2025. [paper]
7. Nishchal Sapkota, Yejia Zhang, **Zihao Zhao**, et al.
Universal Conditional Networks (UniCoN) for Multi-Age Embryonic Cartilage Segmentation with Sparsely Annotated Data
Scientific Reports, 2025, vol. 15, article 3893. [paper]
8. Yunfei Luan, Muhang He, ..., **Zihao Zhao**, et al.
Intelligent Disinfection Robot with High-Touch Surface Detection and Dynamic Pedestrian Avoidance
ICRA, 2024, pp. 3595–3601. [paper]

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

9. Yusong Zhao, **Zihao Zhao**, et al.
SAEPO: Sparse-Autoencoder-Guided Token-Level Credit Assignment for Policy Optimization
Manuscript under review, 2026.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
Teaching Assistant: IS 206 Database.

Rutgers University–New Brunswick
Teaching Assistant: CS 211 Computer Architecture; CS 462 Introduction to Deep Learning.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SJTU Network & Information Management Office Sept. 2021–Sept. 2023
Senior Student Network Administrator, Core Team Shanghai, China

- Maintained campus wireless infrastructure and resolved connectivity issues for 40,000 students and faculty members.
- Authored technical documentation and mentored two junior administrators; contributed more than 300 hours of service.

AWARDS & HONORS

- **National First Prize**, TI Cup China Undergraduate Electronics Design Contest 2023
Top 1%; one of only two SJTU teams to receive the National First Prize.
- **Enterprise Scholarship**, Shanghai Jiao Tong University 2023
CNY 10,000; one of the top two students in the Zhiyuan Honors Program.
- **Zhiyuan Honor Scholarship**, Shanghai Jiao Tong University (CNY 15,000) 2021–2023
- **President’s Prize**, Shanghai Jiao Tong University 2022
- **Merit Student**, Shanghai Jiao Tong University 2022
- **Alumni Scholarship**, Shanghai Jiao Tong University 2022
- **First Prize**, Chinese Chemistry Olympiad (top 1%) 2020

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewer: ACL Rolling Review (2025–2026); NeurIPS (2026).